

# Group Project Assignment 1: Societal Problem Definition

## Article:

<https://www.theguardian.com/commentisfree/2025/jun/30/rents-amsterdam-affordable-newcomers-social-housing>

Source of the article:



This news article was written by Dr Amber Howard and published on 30 Jun 2025 in “The Guardian”, a British daily newspaper.

## Challenges:

### 1. Why are you interested in this topic

The housing crisis in the Netherlands, especially in Amsterdam, is a problem that has affected both local residents and newcomers for many years, yet the situation has shown little improvement.

Amsterdam is a city with a population of almost one million people. The article highlights that housing prices in the Netherlands have increased significantly, making it increasingly difficult for many people to afford housing in the capital. As a result, some residents are forced to leave the city, while others face housing insecurity or homelessness. The article also mentions an increase in homelessness, showing that the housing crisis is not only an economic issue but also a serious social challenge.

We are interested in this topic because housing is a basic human need, and the increasing cost and limited availability of housing can strongly affect people's quality of life, financial stability, and ability to remain part of their community.

### 2. Who are the stakeholders? To whom this article is relevant

There are several stakeholders affected by the housing crisis in Amsterdam. One of the main groups is local residents, especially the people with low or middle income. It's

increasingly difficult for the younger generations to become homeowners, therefore more and more people depend on rentals, whether on social housing or the private sector. Amsterdam being a European capital, there is also a large population of expats who are affected by the prices and lack of availability, especially if their home countries are not as affluent as the Netherlands, or due to their savings, upon moving, being in a currency weaker than the euro. Students who are pursuing a degree in the Netherlands are also strongly affected, as it is difficult to balance attending a university with having a job, so most depend on the savings and income of their families, an income that, as in my previous point, is often constrained by the local salaries and the currency of the home country.

Landlords and properties owners, real estate developers and the municipality Amsterdam is another important group of stakeholders. The national housing policies, regulations and investments can influence the availability and affordability of housing.

**Per team member, find, select, and read a different scientific peer-reviewed article on this topic**

1. Hochstenbach, C. (2025). Framing the housing crisis: politicization and depoliticization of the Dutch housing debate. *Housing Studies*, 40(5), 1226–1251. <https://doi.org/10.1080/02673037.2024.2344844>, Original article.
2. Gentili, M., & Hoekstra, J. (2026). The Position of Young Adults on the Amsterdam Housing Market. Combining the Housing Pathway and the Capability Approach. *Housing, Theory and Society*, 43(1), 74–97. <https://doi.org/10.1080/14036096.2025.2551209>, Original article
3. Arundel, R., Li, A., Baker, E., & Bentley, R. (2024). Housing unaffordability and mental health: dynamics across age and tenure. *International Journal of Housing Policy*, 24(1), 44–74. <https://doi.org/10.1080/19491247.2022.2106541>
4. Ruben Tarne & Dirk Bezemer (2025), “Roof or real estate? An agent-based model of housing affordability in the Netherlands”, *Structural Change and Economic Dynamics*, 72, 163-178 <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.strueco.2024.11.014>, Original article.

These articles are relevant for understanding the challenge that we have selected because they all refer to the housing crisis in Amsterdam and problems with the Dutch housing market. Together, these articles show that the housing crisis isn't a result of just not enough affordable houses. Hochstenbach points out that the debate mostly focuses on young adults and the middle class. Gentili & Hoekstra depict how young adults actually experience the

housing system in Amsterdam. Tarne & Bezemer show the housing affordability is also about interest rates and other factors. Arundel et al. connects the problem to real world consequences, more specifically showing a link to worsening mental health, especially for young renters.